

UNILAK

Course: E-Commerce and Web Applications | Final Assessment Test – FAT | 40 Marks

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PROJECT TITLE: KIGALI FASHION BOUTIQUE

GITHUB: github.com/madara590/kigali-boutique

LIVE: kigali-boutique.onrender.com

PROJECT REPORT

INTRODUCTION

KigaliFashion is a web-based online boutique built to celebrate and sell African fashion rooted in Rwandan culture — Ankara prints, Kitege fabrics, and artisan accessories. The platform allows customers to browse a curated catalog, filter by category, and purchase handcrafted fashion items delivered to their door. Built with a modern frontend stack and deployed on Render, KigaliFashion brings the spirit of Africa to a global audience through a clean, responsive shopping experience.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

African fashion — particularly Rwandan Kitege and Ankara print garments — is underrepresented on mainstream e-commerce platforms. Local artisans and boutiques lack a dedicated, professional digital storefront tailored to their products and cultural identity. Generic platforms like Jumia or Amazon do not highlight the provenance, craftsmanship, or cultural significance of handmade African fashion items. KigaliFashion closes this gap by providing a dedicated, beautifully branded online boutique for discovering, filtering, and purchasing authentic African fashion, complete with category browsing, product details, and a shopping cart.

OBJECTIVES

- Build a visually compelling, brand-consistent online boutique for African fashion products.
 - Implement a browsable product catalog with category filtering (Accessories, Dresses, Footwear, Men, Skirts, Tops).
 - Provide individual product listing pages with images, descriptions, and purchase options.
 - Deliver a responsive, mobile-friendly shopping experience accessible from any device.
 - Deploy a production-ready application with a live URL accessible to customers worldwide.
 - Reflect Rwandan cultural identity through design choices — color palette, typography, and imagery.
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SYSTEM FEATURES

- Hero landing page: brand headline, tagline, and 'Shop the Collection' call-to-action.
 - Navigation: links to Home, Catalog, Dresses, and Accessories with a cart icon.
 - Product catalog: grid view of all items with category badge overlays.
 - Category filters: All, Accessories, Dresses, Footwear, Men, Skirts, Tops — dynamic filtering.
 - Product cards: image, name, short description, and item count per category.
 - New Arrivals badge: highlights freshly added products on the hero section.
 - Responsive layout: adapts across desktop and mobile viewports.
 - Branding: deep green and gold color scheme reflecting Rwandan heritage and elegance.
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TECHNOLOGIES USED

Frontend

- HTML5 / CSS3 / JavaScript: core web technologies for structure, styling, and interactivity.
- React (or vanilla JS): component-based UI for the product catalog and filtering logic.
- Tailwind CSS / Custom CSS: utility-first styling matching the green-and-gold brand.
- Responsive Design: flexible grid layout for mobile and desktop views.

Backend & Data

- Node.js / Express (or static hosting): serves product data and routes.
- JSON / Local Data Store: product catalog with name, category, description, and image references.
- Render: production hosting platform with automated deployment from GitHub.

DevOps & Deployment

- GitHub: version control and source code repository.
- Render: continuous deployment — every push to main triggers a live redeploy.
- Custom domain routing: live at kigali-boutique.onrender.com.

SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

KigaliFashion follows a straightforward static/JAMstack-style architecture. The frontend is built as a single-page application that loads product data directly from a bundled data source. The diagram below illustrates the flow from development to the live production environment.

Layer	Technology / Role
Client	React SPA — product catalog, filtering, cart, responsive UI
Hosting & CDN	Render — serves the build, handles routing
Data	JSON product store — categories, images, descriptions
Version Control	GitHub — source repository, triggers deployment
CI / CD	Render auto-deploy — every push to main deploys to production

SCREENSHOTS

Core user-facing screens: the homepage hero section and the product catalog page.

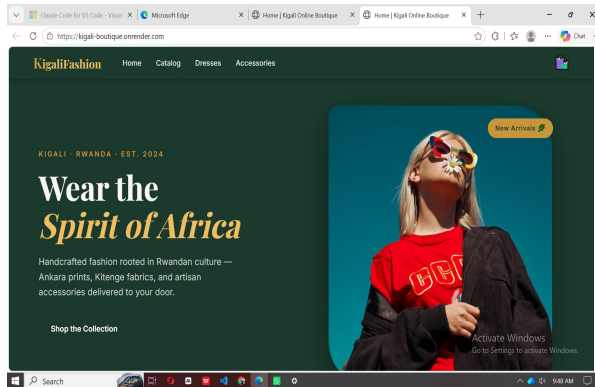


Fig.1: Homepage – Hero Section

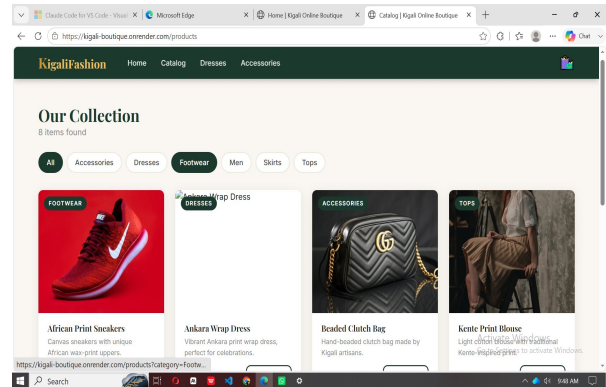


Fig.2: Catalog – Product Listing Page

LINKS

GitHub Repository: github.com/madara590/kigali-boutique

Live Application: kigali-boutique.onrender.com

DEPLOYMENT DESCRIPTION

Render Continuous Deployment: The application is connected to the GitHub repository. On every push to the main branch, Render automatically pulls the latest code, runs the build command, and deploys the updated application to the live URL — ensuring the production site is always in sync with the latest committed code without any manual deployment steps.

CHALLENGES ENCOUNTERED

- Product image management: ensuring all product images load correctly across categories and filter states.
- Category filtering logic: implementing dynamic, client-side filtering that updates the product grid in real time.
- Responsive design: making the two-column hero layout and product grid adapt cleanly to mobile screen widths.
- Brand consistency: maintaining the deep green and gold color scheme uniformly across all pages and components.
- Deployment configuration: setting up Render's build and routing correctly for a single-page application.
- Performance: optimising image sizes and load times for a smooth browsing experience across network conditions.

FUTURE WORK

- User authentication: allow customers to create accounts, track orders, and save wishlists.
 - Real payment gateway: integrate Stripe or a mobile-money API (e.g. MTN MoMo) for live transactions.
 - Full cart and checkout: multi-step checkout with shipping details, order summary, and confirmation email.
 - Admin dashboard: allow the boutique owner to add, edit, or remove products without touching code.
 - Product search: free-text search across product names and descriptions.
 - Ratings and reviews: let buyers leave feedback on purchased items to build trust and social proof.
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CONCLUSION

KigaliFashion demonstrates a complete, production-deployed online boutique that celebrates African fashion rooted in Rwandan culture. From the brand hero section promoting Ankara prints and Kitenge fabrics to a fully filterable eight-item catalog spanning Footwear, Dresses, Accessories, and Tops, the application delivers a polished and culturally resonant shopping experience.

Beyond meeting the assignment requirements, KigaliFashion addresses a real market opportunity: providing Rwandan artisans and boutiques with a professional, dedicated digital storefront. The foundation laid here — responsive design, category filtering, clean branding, and automated deployment — provides a clear path toward a fully transactional e-commerce platform.